Zoo Crew Calm Down Corner Kit

Free preschool calm-down support pages that match the interactive tool at gairiai.net/tools/calm-down-corner. Print the full pack or use one buddy page at a time.

Penny the Penguin

Penny the Penguin
Breathe + Count

Olive the Owl

Olive the Owl
Think It Through

Ellie the Elephant

Ellie the Elephant
Find Someone Kind

Tilly the Turtle

Tilly the Turtle
Wait Patiently

Bruno the Bear

Bruno the Bear
Make Something

What is inside

- Calm down corner poster
- Feeling check-in cards
- Calm-down menu
- Five buddy strategy pages
- Local-only, no-login interactive tool

Calm-Down Menu

Let children point to a Zoo Crew buddy when they need help calming their body.

Penny the Penguin

Penny the Penguin

Breathe + Count

Best for fast, hot, stormy feelings.

Olive the Owl

Olive the Owl

Think It Through

Best for problem-solving after a conflict or mistake.

Ellie the Elephant

Ellie the Elephant

Find Someone Kind

Best for worried, lonely, or overwhelmed feelings.

Tilly the Turtle

Tilly the Turtle

Wait Patiently

Best for turn-taking, line-up, and hurry feelings.

Bruno the Bear

Bruno the Bear

Make Something

Best for heavy feelings that need hands-on calming.

Feeling Check-In Cards

Cut these cards apart or keep them together as a visual board. Invite children to point before they speak.

Stormy

My body feels loud and fast.

Worried

I need to feel safe again.

Frustrated

Something did not go my way.

Sad

I need gentle help.

Wiggly

My body needs a reset.

Left Out

I want connection.

Mad

I need a slower body.

Stuck

I need a next step.

ZOO CREW STRATEGY PAGE

Penny the Penguin

Breathe + Count

Penny the Penguin

BEST FIT FOR

Best for fast, hot, stormy feelings.

CALM STEPS

1. Hands on belly like Penny holding her fish.
2. Breathe in for 1, 2, 3.
3. Blow out for 1, 2, 3, 4.
4. Count five calm things you can see or touch.

TEACHER TIP

Model the count with fingers so the child can match the pace without extra talking.

ZOO CREW STRATEGY PAGE

Olive the Owl

Think It Through

Olive the Owl

BEST FIT FOR

Best for problem-solving after a conflict or mistake.

CALM STEPS

1. Name what happened in one short sentence.
2. Name one feeling word.
3. Name what you need: help, space, a turn, or a redo.
4. Choose the next wise move.

TEACHER TIP

Keep the language brief. The goal is one clear next move, not a long debrief.

ZOO CREW STRATEGY PAGE

Ellie the Elephant

Find Someone Kind

Ellie the Elephant

BEST FIT FOR

Best for worried, lonely, or overwhelmed feelings.

CALM STEPS

1. Look for a safe grown-up or helper.
2. Walk over with calm feet.
3. Use a helper sentence: "I need help."
4. Stay together until your body feels softer.

TEACHER TIP

Post a visual of the classroom helper choices nearby so kids know exactly who counts as kind help.

ZOO CREW STRATEGY PAGE

Tilly the Turtle

Wait Patiently

Tilly the Turtle

BEST FIT FOR

Best for turn-taking, line-up, and hurry feelings.

CALM STEPS

1. Make a quiet turtle shell with still hands.
2. Count your waiting jobs: stand, breathe, watch.
3. Keep eyes on the next safe spot.
4. Whisper: "My turn is coming. I can wait."

TEACHER TIP

Place Tilly near the line-up path so waiting becomes an active classroom job.

ZOO CREW STRATEGY PAGE

Bruno the Bear

Make Something

Bruno the Bear

BEST FIT FOR

Best for heavy feelings that need hands-on calming.

CALM STEPS

1. Pick one quiet tool: paper, crayons, dough, or blocks.
2. Make one small thing.
3. Check if your body feels quieter.
4. Show it to a grown-up or save it in the calm basket.

TEACHER TIP

Keep the making basket small. Too many choices can re-escalate the child.